Gmail

Robare Pruyn <robare@qtrial.app>

Stuff to Review

Deborah Pruyn <deb@qtrial.app> Wed, Apr 22, 2026 at 9:05 PM
To: robare@qtrial.app

Hey Mom!

I've been designing QTrial's database that holds every dog, every owner, every entry, every score, every fee, etc. The design is detailed and technical, but the ideas in it should all be familiar (it's built off of all the info you sent me and questions you answered). This document walks through the structure in plain language. Can you review all of this to check my assumptions?

Things to look for as you read:

- **"That's wrong."** If I've modeled something in a way that doesn't match how it actually works.
- **"You're missing X."** If I've left out something you actually need.
- **"Y never happens."** If I've modeled a scenario that isn't real.
- **"You're overcomplicating Z."** If the structure is fancier than the reality.

You don't have to read every sentence carefully, just to scan for things that feel off.

The fundamental shape

QTrial's database is organized as a tree, starting from clubs:

Club (Glens Falls Kennel Club)
├── Users (people with accounts at the club)

- CLuster Name,
- If mixed breeds are allowed)any exclusion)
- Allowed Breeds, mixed breeds,
- Breeds excluded
- Event Secratary
- Trial Chair
- Location

├── Events (a weekend, usually, with one or more days)

- Event #)assigned by AKC
- # triasl in one day(there may be 2 trials in one day)

│ ├── Days
│ │ └── Trials (the actual competition units)
│ │ ├── Classes being offered (and Judge Assignment)

- Class Limits
- Opening date
- Closing date
- Start time

- Jumbp height order(short to Tall, Tall to short)

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│   │   │   ├── Judge assignments
│   │   │   └── Trial awards (HIT, HC, etc.)
│   ├── Teams (for Team Obedience, Rally Team) (This is very rarely used)
│   ├── Owners and their dogs
│   ├── Entries (one dog, one event)(Can be entered is multiple classes)
│   │   └── Entry lines (that dog in each class)
│   │       └── Results (score, time, placement)
│   └── Payments and refunds
├── Judges directory
└── Email templates
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Everything below "Club" is isolated (So for example, GFKC's data never mingles with any other club's data). That's enforced at the database level.

The key distinction: event → day → trial

You already know this is important, but I want to confirm we have it right:

- **Event**: "Glens Falls Kennel Club Fall 2026 Obedience & Rally Trial." One event. One premium list. One venue.
- **Day**: Saturday. Sunday. Each one is a separate "Day" row.
- **Trial**: The actual AKC-numbered competition unit. Most days have one Obedience trial in the morning and one in the afternoon. Some days have a Rally trial and an Obedience trial running side-by-side. Each trial has its own AKC event number.
- *So I don't know whether this counts here but there is the grey are between the closing dat and the actual trial where the running order is set, numbers for armbands, and final confirmation letters email(contining the numbers, plus the stewarts board and judges book are prepared for the day of trial)*

The event has the venue, the overall dates, the armband scheme. The trials have the classes, fees, judges, and awards.

Check: does this three-level structure match how you think about it? Or do you naturally think of "Saturday morning Rally" as one thing without separating the day from the trial?If and when we have 2 trial in a day I treat them as different trials. Each has its own judges book but the catalog should have all trials. I think I sent you a copyof the catalog.

Dogs, owners, and handlers

Here's where we made some deliberate model choices after your Q&A answers.

Dogs live at the club level✓

Each club has its own "dog directory." If a dog has competed at GFKC before, it's in GFKC's directory. If the same dog competes at a different club that uses QTrial, it gets a new record there.

This is intentional (for now). It keeps things simple for the MVP. Down the road we might want to allow dogs to exist as objects across clubs, but not now. (This is what we want to do long term, yes?)

Co-ownership is first-class✓

Based on your Q2 answer ("co-owners get registered on the dog record, not the entry"), we've modeled this as:

- Each dog has one or more owner records attached to it
- One owner is marked "primary"
- The others are co-owners. Each co-owner gets their own entry in the system, the same way the primary owner does, with proper fields for name, address, and contact info.

This replaces the old approach of stuffing "Smith, Jane & Smith, Bob & Jones, Alice" into a single text field. Now you can actually search for and display co-owner info easily.

Handler is usually the owner, sometimes not✓

You confirmed that in performance events, handler = owner for roughly 99% of entries. The exception is junior handlers. So we're modeling it this way:

- The entry says who the handler is (usually just "same as primary owner")✓
- If a junior handles the dog in a specific class, that's recorded at the class level with their AKC junior handler number✓
- No professional handler flag (they don't exist in performance)✓

Check: does "99% same as owner" feel right? Are there other exceptions we haven't thought of besides junior handlers?

Jump height is per-dog-per-trial **Jump height is recorded on entry. On leash classes have no jumps.**

Your Q1 answer clarified this: jump height is set once per dog for the whole trial. If Buddy jumps 20" in Novice B at Saturday AM's Obedience trial, he jumps 20" in every jumping class he's entered in at that trial.✓

The rare exception is a judge measuring the dog in-ring and overriding the height for the rest of the trial. We've modeled that too.

Check: the ~once-per-career judge-measurement scenario — is that really how often it comes up? Any other cases where height would change within a trial? Never. Once the dog reaches adult size the jump height is fixed for that event. If can change by event(ex: agility max height is 20", Rally 16", Obedience 24" and so on)

Entries — the core concept

An "entry" in QTrial means: "This dog is competing at this event." It's the thing an exhibitor pays for and receives a confirmation for.

Within an entry, there are "entry lines" — one per class the dog is entered in. So if Buddy is entered in Novice B, Open A, and Rally Advanced A at the Saturday trial, that's one entry with three entry lines. I have attached a copy of the latest premium of the current event I am working. The entry for is ini that but I have also attached the latest "official" AKC entry form. they do change it up occasionally.

The distinction matters because:

- Armbands go on the entry (or specifically, per armband series) No, Armband # are figured after all the entries are in and are computed by class and jump height order. I usually do them by 100's because I think it is clearer. But some people choose to go by 10's of 50's. In other words 100- Novice A, 200's Novie B, 300's Intermedeate etc.
- Fees are calculated per-line (first entry vs additional)
- State transitions (scratched, absent, excused, DQ) happen at the line level, not the entry level✓

No refunds after closing date without vet excuse. In scoring there is ABS, DQ EXC, (With Exc a reason must be give.)

Armbands

Based on what we learned from the Nov 2025 GFKC catalog, we're modeling armbands as:

- One armband per (dog, trial, armband series)
- A dog running Advanced B + Excellent B + Master (all in the 500 series) gets ONE armband (Okay so this is the way I do it for the "B" classes only. My reasoning is because so many of the dogs competeing in the B classes are in multiple classes in one trial going for the advanced titles like RAE and RACH. It is easier to compute the High in trial and high triple, which has to happen in the trial, when the dog has one # across classes. You don't have to do it that way. Each class can have a different number but it does make it more confusing at the end. FYI(in case you have't figured it the dog with the highest total score and time in Advanced/Excellend and Adv/Exe/Masters.
- The same dog also running Rally Choice (800 series) gets a SECOND armband. Yes because it is no included in the HIT or High triple.

Armband 509 in your Nov 2025 catalog showed up in all four of those classes for the same dog — that's what drove the design.

Check: does the "series" concept match how you think about armband numbering? Or do you think of it more simply (e.g., "one number per dog per trial, with the series determining the starting range")? One number per dog per trial and is the dog is in multiple trials they can keep the same number for the weekend.✓

Fees and money

Money is handled carefully:

- Every dollar amount is stored precisely (no floating-point approximation)✓
- Every payment has a method (check, credit card, money order, cash, coupon)✓ Check #
- Check payments track deposit status✓ Newbies are often confused about the discount and so have their entry held up.
- Refunds link back to specific payments✓
- AKC fees ($3.50 first entry, $3.00 additional, $10 secretary fee after 12 trials/year) are stored as configurable data, not hardcoded — so when AKC changes rates, we just add a new row I do believe the AKC fee has gone up to $4. have to double check that.

AKC submission

Per your Q4 answer, for MVP we're building PDF-based submission — not XML. The three artifacts are:

1. Marked catalog (PDF)
2. Judges books (with pink carbon copies to AKC) No Judges book original goes to AKC with the judges signiture., Judge gets a copy and so does host club.Thats why I don't see how we can do the final all online unless they change the rules.
3. Form JOVRY8 (for Rally) or equivalent (for Obedience)✓

Sent via email to rallyresults@akc.org or mailed to PO Box 900051 in Raleigh.✓

We're storing a record of every submission attempt so there's a paper trail.✓

Catalogs and judges books

The catalog is generated from the data, not hand-assembled. For each class:✓

- Dogs listed by armband
- Full registered name with prefix titles and suffix titles rendered correctly
- Breed, sire, dam, owner(s), handler
- After the trial, scores and placements annotated

Judges books are generated similarly — one PDF per judge per class, with armband + call name + breed + score columns. No names of dogs in Judges book or on Stewards sheets of Armbands. Only Number and breed of Dog.

The layout follows the boxes in the old Obedience Solution's judges book template (which we copied directly from your seed data).

Check: does the "generate from data" approach match your expectations? Are there parts of the catalog you hand-tune that we should preserve?

What the database does NOT do

We want to be clear about what's not in scope for MVP:

- No pedigree tracking (sire/dam are free text, not a graph)✓
- No cross-club dog matching (each club has its own dog records)✓
- No automatic title advancement (you tell the system when a dog earns CDX; it doesn't auto-detect)✓
- No agility-specific features (that's post-MVP)✓ She has a separate datbase for agility.which I do not have
- No mailing-list functionality beyond the basics. I should be able to generate and email directly, the final confirmation letter with the dog/s number/s and also be able to attach the running achedule.
- No conformation, no scent work, no barn hunt trials (though we seed barn hunt titles for dogs that have them) Maybe at a later date.

Check: are any of these things that you actually need for your first real trial?

Open questions for you

These are the things we flagged during design that we still need your input on:

1. **Paper entries**: what do you do with the paper after entering the data? Staple the check? Keep the paper? We want to mirror your physical workflow. I keep all the entries to gether with the check in original envelope. AKC(if they come) needs to know I have access to the original.
2. **Trial-day contingencies**: late judges, dog bites, judge excusals — the system should stay out of your way. What are the things you actually click/type while something chaotic is happening? They usually send me the paperwork for that as well as Junior handler. Hopefully I don't need it.
3. **Check refunds**: do you write a check by hand, or do you have a bill-pay service that does it? That has to go through the treasurer.
4. **Print logistics**: do you print catalogs yourself or send to a print shop? What quality do catalogs need to be? I print all this stuff.
5. **Judge communication**: how do you currently send judges their schedules? Email? Mail? Email
6. **Move-up deadlines**: what version of AKC regulations specifies the 2026 move-up deadline rules? We need to cite the right document. I print them out in advance of the trial. They are attached to the paper work I send to the AKC.
7. **Senior Handler**: does this actually come up at AKC Obedience/Rally trials? We've left it out of the MVP model. Never had to deal with it nor have I heard of anyone wanting it or getting special favor for it.

[Quoted text hidden]

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2 attachments

GFKC AKC Rally Premium June 2026 .pdf
2226K

AEN999.pdf
797K